

Trio Pizza

One box, three flavors. Same kitchen, bigger orders.

What It Is

Trio Pizza is a pizzeria format built on a single packaging twist: instead of one large single-flavor pizza, you sell a box of three individual pizzas so each person can mix flavors in one order. Customers feel they get more variety and a more fun experience, while the business quietly raises average order value and moves more product — no new recipes required, just a smarter way to sell.

How It Makes Money

You sell trio boxes at a premium to a single large pizza (\$22-\$32 per box of three) for dine-in, takeout, and delivery. Customers are families, friend groups, office lunches, and indecisive solo diners who want to try multiple flavors. The format lifts ticket size and order frequency. Works as a new pizzeria, a menu retrofit for an existing one, or a delivery-only ghost kitchen.

Startup Costs

- Pizza oven (deck or conveyor): \$2,000-\$12,000 (used lowers this)
- Prep tables, fridge, dough mixer: \$1,500-\$5,000
- Custom trio boxes + packaging: \$300-\$1,000
- Initial ingredient stock: \$500-\$1,500
- POS + online ordering (GoHighLevel/site): \$97-\$300/month
- Permits, food license, commissary/kitchen lease: \$1,000-\$5,000+
- Branding, signage, menu design: \$500-\$2,000
- **Realistic start: \$8,000-\$30,000** (far lower as a ghost kitchen or menu add-on to an existing pizzeria)

Sourcing: Buy custom trio boxes and packaging from Alibaba — search "individual pizza box trio," "custom printed pizza box," and "kraft food box bulk." Source ingredients and dough supplies from local restaurant wholesale.

The Numbers

- Cost per trio box (3 small pizzas + box): ~\$4.50-\$7.00
- Sell price: \$22-\$32
- Profit per box: ~\$15-\$24 (before labor/rent)
- Slow day: 30 boxes → ~\$540 profit
- Strong day (lunch + dinner rush): 120-180 boxes → ~\$2,200-\$3,600 profit
- Monthly at a steady location: \$15,000-\$35,000+ gross profit before fixed costs

How To Start

1. Develop 6-8 individual-size pizza flavors that travel and bake consistently.
2. Design the trio box and a mix-and-match ordering flow (in-store and online).
3. Decide format — new shop, ghost kitchen, or adding the trio to an existing pizzeria's menu.

4. Sort equipment, permits, and a commissary/kitchen lease.
5. Set trio pricing above a single large pizza and build combo upsells (drinks, sides).
6. Launch with delivery-app listings plus your own online ordering page.
7. Push the "try three flavors" angle hard in content and reviews.

Where To Get Customers

- Delivery apps (DoorDash, Uber Eats, Grubhub) — the variety angle stands out in listings
- Instagram and TikTok — the three-flavor box is photogenic and shareable
- Google Business Profile + "pizza near me" search
- Local office lunch and group-order outreach
- Family and neighborhood Facebook groups, plus loyalty/referral offers

Pro Tips

- Anchor the trio against a single large pizza so customers see "more variety for a little more" — that framing is the whole upsell.
- Push group and office orders (multiple trios at once); larger tickets with the same kitchen effort are where margin compounds.
- Test the format as an add-on to an existing pizzeria first — you validate demand before paying for a full buildout.